NIKHIL RAJ

Senior DevOps / SRE Engineer

nikhilrajbu@gmail.com | +91 8759747230 | India (Remote)

GitHub: github.com/NikhilRaj-DevOps | LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/nikhilraj-devops

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Senior DevOps / SRE Engineer with 8+ years of experience designing and managing scalable CI/CD pipelines, cloud infrastructure, and containerized workloads across Azure, GCP, and AWS. Proven track record in AIOps, cloud migrations (On-Prem to GCP, Azure to GCP), infrastructure-as-code, and SRE incident management. Certified Azure Administrator (AZ-104) skilled in Kubernetes, Terraform, Jenkins, ArgoCD, Ansible, and full-stack monitoring.

CORE SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

CI/CD & DevOps Tools: Jenkins, ArgoCD, Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, Helm, K8s Kustomization, Git

Containerization & Orchestration: Docker, Kubernetes (AKS, GKE, Rancher), Helm, K9s, Lens

Cloud Platforms: Microsoft Azure (AKS, ACR, Azure DevOps), Google Cloud Platform (GKE, GCS), AWS, On-Premise (VMware ESXi, HPE Nimble)

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, Ansible

Scripting Languages: Python, PowerShell, Shell/Bash, Groovy

Monitoring & Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, DataDog, Elasticsearch, Kibana, Humio, New Relic, PagerDuty

AI Tools: GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, ChatGPT

Databases: MS SQL, Oracle, MySQL, MongoDB, VerticaDB, Cassandra

Big Data & Streaming: Kafka, Spark

Methodologies: Agile (Scrum, Kanban), SRE, ITIL Incident Management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior DevOps Engineer | Aziro | India (Remote)

June 2022 – Present

HPE InfoSight – AIOps Platform (2023 – Present) — HPE

AIOps cloud platform leveraging machine learning to automate infrastructure operations and support.

- Led VMware ESXi farm migration, transitioning data and servers to the new ESXi infrastructure with zero data loss.
- Managed Dev, Beta, and Production build pipelines using Jenkins and automated weekly deployments via ArgoCD in the Kubernetes Rancher environment, ensuring consistent and reliable release cadence.
- Administered Kubernetes clusters end-to-end across 50+ nodes (1TB RAM and 126 CPUs per node) on Rancher — equivalent to 6,300+ total CPU cores running production AIOps workloads — managing namespace isolation, RBAC policies, resource quotas, and network policies to enforce security and multi-tenancy.
- Authored and maintained Kubernetes manifests and Kustomization overlays for environment-specific (Dev/Beta/Prod) configuration management without code duplication.
- Diagnosed and resolved Kubernetes pod failures, CrashLoopBackOff errors, OOMKilled events, and node resource pressure issues to maintain platform stability.
- Monitored Kubernetes workloads using Prometheus and Grafana dashboards; configured HPA (Horizontal Pod Autoscaler) rules to handle traffic spikes automatically.
- Leveraged AI tools (GitHub Copilot, Claude Code) to develop a Python script to fetch HPE Nimble array and datastore/volume utilization metrics, ingested the data into Prometheus via custom exporters, and built dedicated Grafana dashboards for real-time infrastructure visibility.
- Executed RHEL OS upgrades from version 6 to 7 across production servers, ensuring minimal downtime.
- Monitored production systems using Prometheus, Grafana, and Humio; responded to PagerDuty alerts with an average incident resolution time of 15–30 minutes, maintaining strong SLA compliance.

- Performed root-cause analysis (RCA) on production incidents, implemented temporary fixes, and authored post-incident reports.
- Coordinated escalations across engineering teams and maintained SLA compliance through structured follow-ups.
- Leveraged AI tools including GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, and ChatGPT to accelerate scripting, automate boilerplate generation, and improve code quality across infrastructure and automation tasks.

Tools & Technologies: Jenkins, ArgoCD, Kubernetes, Rancher, Kustomize, Helm, Python, RHEL/CentOS, Ansible, VMware ESXi, Nimble Array, HPE Proliant, Docker, Prometheus, Grafana, Humio, PagerDuty, Kafka, Spark, Cassandra, VerticaDB, Vault, GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, ChatGPT

Bakkt – Crypto & Loyalty Platform **(2022 – 2023) — Bakkt**

Fintech platform enabling crypto and loyalty product experiences for enterprise customers.

- Collaborated with Dev and QA teams to troubleshoot container and Kubernetes pod issues across multiple environments (Dev, QA, UAT, Prod).
- Executed Azure-to-GCP cloud migration for the Marketplace project, minimizing service disruption.
- Delivered On-Premises-to-GCP migration for the Loyalty project, re-architecting infrastructure for cloud-native scalability.
- Managed and maintained environment provisioning and deployments using Terraform and Azure DevOps pipelines.
- Administered access control for Azure, FusionAuth, and database resources across development teams.

Tools & Technologies: Jenkins, GCP, Azure Cloud, On-Prem Infra, Azure DevOps, Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes, PowerShell, Lens

Developer III – DevOps Engineer | UST | India (Remote)

January 2021 – June 2022

SmartOps – AI-Powered Cognitive Automation Platform **(2021 – 2022) — UST**

AI-driven platform for digitizing and optimizing manual enterprise workflows.

- Built and published Docker images via Jenkins pipelines; packaged Kubernetes application deployments using Helm charts.
- Automated multi-cloud Docker image deployments to Azure, AWS, and GCP using Python scripting, supporting a daily deployment cadence across all environments.
- Managed Infrastructure as Code using Terraform for repeatable, auditable environment provisioning.
- Implemented cost optimization across all non-production AI/ML environments (Dev, QA, UAT) by automating scheduled shutdowns during non-office hours & weekends using Jenkins pipelines, achieving ~20% reduction in cloud infrastructure spend.
- Developed an Azure PowerShell-based internal vulnerability assessment tool for Azure Cloud Infrastructure, recognized with the USTAR Super Star Award.

Tools & Technologies: Jenkins, Azure Cloud, Azure DevOps, Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, Python, Bash, AKS, ACR, K9s, Git, Grafana, Kibana, Elasticsearch, Linux, AWS, GCS

Programmer Analyst – DevOps Engineer | Cognizant | Pune, India

March 2018 – January 2021

TriZetto NetworX – Healthcare Provider Network Management **(2018 – 2021) — Cognizant**

Integrated provider data management platform automating complex pricing scenarios for payers, providers, and patients.

- Automated end-to-end build, release, and deployment workflows for both On-Premises and Azure servers using Jenkins and PowerShell.
- Configured and migrated application servers and databases from On-Premises to Azure Cloud for UAT and production environments.
- Implemented monitoring and alerting for application servers and Jenkins using Prometheus and Grafana, reducing MTTR.
- Won the Innovation Award for automating Windows MSI application deployment, eliminating manual errors and reducing application downtime to 3 minutes using Jenkins and PowerShell.

Tools & Technologies: Jenkins, PowerShell, Shell Scripting, Azure Cloud, Azure DevOps, Azure Boards, Git, Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, Python, Windows Server, Prometheus, Grafana

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate (AZ-104)
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)

ACHIEVEMENTS & AWARDS

- Innovation Award – Cognizant (TriZetto NetworX): Automated Windows MSI application deployment using Jenkins and PowerShell, eliminating human errors and reducing application downtime to 3 minutes.
- USTAR Super Star Award – UST (SmartOps): Recognized with the title 'Born to Learn' for developing an internal Azure Cloud infrastructure vulnerability assessment tool.

EDUCATION

B.E. in Electronics and Communication Engineering

The University of Burdwan | 2017